Pro route · Vocabulary and grammar (C2 Proficiency)

LS1 has no Pro pages on the site: this is a C2 extension of the same topics (routines, useful expressions, phrasal verbs, healthy habits), for revision and for the exam.

How to study it

First all the vocabulary, then all the grammar, Learning Path by Learning Path. Learning Path 1 (a warm-up) and Learning Path 6 (the final product) have no new vocabulary or grammar.

Vocabulary: cover the meaning column and define each word in your own words; then write a new example sentence of your own, as precise as the one in the table.

Grammar: read how it works, cover the answer column and do the transformations; then check and read why. In the exam, small spelling mistakes cost the mark.

1 · Vocabulary

Learning Path 2 · A day in real life

Word or expression	Meaning	Example
Routine and time · 9		
a creature of habit	someone who always does the same things in the same way	*My dad is a creature of habit: same breakfast every day.*
like clockwork	happening regularly and exactly as planned	*The 7.42 bus arrives like clockwork.*
the daily grind	the boring, tiring routine of work or school	*By Thursday the daily grind starts to wear me down.*
to be stuck in a rut	to be in a boring situation that never changes	*I felt stuck in a rut, so I joined the climbing club.*
at the crack of dawn	very early in the morning	*Bakers start work at the crack of dawn.*
to burn the midnight oil	to work or study late into the night	*I burnt the midnight oil before the exam.*
to cram (something) in	to fit a lot of activities into a short time	*We crammed in three museums in one afternoon.*
to fritter away (time)	to waste time on unimportant things	*I frittered away the evening on my phone.*
to while away (the hours)	to spend time pleasantly when there is nothing else to do	*We whiled away the afternoon playing cards.*
Collocations · 5		
a gruelling schedule	an extremely tiring timetable	*Athletes keep a gruelling training schedule.*
to keep regular hours	to go to bed and get up at the same times	*Keeping regular hours helps you sleep better.*
to snatch (a bite / some sleep)	to get a little of something quickly, when you can	*I snatched a sandwich between classes.*

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Word or expression	Meaning	Example
a hectic pace	a very busy, fast rhythm	*I can't keep up this hectic pace much longer.*
to be pressed for time	to have very little time	*Sorry, I'm a bit pressed for time today.*

Learning Path 3 · Useful expressions

Word or expression	Meaning	Example
Phrasal verbs: the day · 8		
to drag yourself out of bed	to get up with great difficulty	*On Mondays I have to drag myself out of bed.*
to lie in	to stay in bed later than usual	*On Sundays I lie in until ten.*
to turn in	to go to bed	*I'm shattered: I'm going to turn in.*
to nod off / to doze off	to fall asleep without meaning to	*I nodded off during the film.*
to wind down	to relax gradually after activity or stress	*Reading helps me wind down before bed.*
to squeeze in	to manage to fit something into a busy timetable	*Can you squeeze in a quick coffee?*
to get round to	to finally do something you have been meaning to do	*I never got round to answering her message.*
to knuckle down	to start working hard and seriously	*With exams next week, it's time to knuckle down.*
Idioms · 5		
to call it a day	to stop working for the day	*We've done enough: let's call it a day.*
to bite the bullet	to do something unpleasant that you have been avoiding	*I bit the bullet and started my project.*
to hit the ground running	to start something with energy and speed	*After the holidays I want to hit the ground running.*
to be on the go	to be very busy and active all the time	*I've been on the go since seven this morning.*
a night owl / an early bird	someone who is most active late at night / early in the morning	*I'm a night owl: I can't think before ten.*

Learning Path 4 · Present Simple & Phrasal verbs

Word or expression	Meaning	Example
Phrasal verbs with nuance · 9		
to fall behind (with)	to fail to keep up with work or a schedule	*I fell behind with my reading when I was ill.*
to keep up with	to move or learn at the same speed as others	*It's hard to keep up with all my subjects.*
to cut down on	to reduce the amount of something	*I'm trying to cut down on screen time.*

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Word or expression	Meaning	Example
to cut out	to stop eating or doing something completely	*She cut out fizzy drinks.*
to come down with	to start to suffer from an illness	*I came down with flu the day before the trip.*
to burn out	to become exhausted from working too hard	*If you never rest, you'll burn out.*
to bounce back	to recover quickly after a problem	*She bounced back after a bad first term.*
to put up with	to accept something annoying without complaining	*I can't put up with the noise any longer.*
to face up to	to accept and deal with a difficult situation	*You need to face up to the problem.*

Learning Path 5 · Healthy habits

Word or expression	Meaning	Example
Health and well-being · 9		
sedentary	involving a lot of sitting and little exercise	*A sedentary lifestyle is bad for your heart.*
sleep deprivation	not getting enough sleep over a period of time	*Sleep deprivation affects concentration.*
to be glued to (a screen)	to look at something constantly	*He's glued to his phone all evening.*
in moderation	in reasonable, not excessive, amounts	*Sweets are fine in moderation.*
wholesome	good for your health or your well-being	*a wholesome breakfast*
to take its toll (on)	to have a gradual harmful effect	*Late nights took their toll on my grades.*
to stave off	to stop something bad from happening for a time	*A short walk staves off the afternoon slump.*
well-being	the state of being healthy and happy	*Exercise improves mental well-being.*
to recharge your batteries	to rest so that you have energy again	*A weekend in the mountains recharges my batteries.*

2 · Grammar

One C2 grammar point per Learning Path, with practice in the style of C2 Proficiency key word transformations (3–8 words, including the word in CAPITALS) and open cloze.

Learning Path 2 · A day in real life

Habits at C2: always, will / would, tend to, used to

How it works

- **Present continuous + always / constantly / forever** for a habit that annoys you: *He's always borrowing my charger.*
- **will / would** for typical, characteristic behaviour (present / past): *She'll sit there for hours.* · *As a child I would spend every summer at the beach.* Stressed *WILL* shows irritation: *He WILL leave his socks on the floor.*

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- **tend to / be prone to / be inclined to** for general tendencies: *Teenagers tend to go to bed late.* · *I'm prone to oversleeping on Mondays.*
- **used to + infinitive** (past habit, now finished) vs **be / get used to + -ing** (be / become accustomed): *I used to walk to school.* · *I'm used to getting up early.* · *I'm getting used to the new timetable.*
- **Exam tip:** would is not possible for past states: *I used to have* (not *would have*) *long hair*.

Practice from the Learning Path, with answers

Sentence	Answer	Why
My brother leaves his things everywhere, which drives me mad. ALWAYS → My brother ___ his things everywhere.	**is always leaving**	Present continuous + always for an annoying habit.
When I was little, my grandmother read to me every night. WOULD → When I was little, my grandmother ___ every night.	**would read to me**	would for a repeated past action.
Teenagers generally go to bed later than adults. TEND → Teenagers ___ bed later than adults.	**tend to go to**	tend to + infinitive.
Getting up at six is no longer hard for me. USED → I ___ up at six.	**am used to getting / have got used to getting**	be / get used to + -ing.
I had a long journey to school in primary, but not any more. USED → I ___ a long journey to school in primary.	**used to have**	Past state: used to, not would.
I often oversleep on Mondays. PRONE → I ___ on Mondays.	**am prone to oversleeping**	be prone to + -ing.
Open cloze: She ___ sit by the window for hours, just watching the street. (characteristic behaviour)	**will**	will for typical present behaviour.
Open cloze: It took me months to get used ___ the new timetable.	**to**	get used to (+ noun / -ing).

Learning Path 3 · Useful expressions

Discourse at C2: concession and contrast

How it works

- **Much as / Although / While** + clause: *Much as I love weekends, I find them hard to organise.*
- **albeit** + adjective / adverb / phrase (= although): *a useful, albeit tiring, routine.*
- **Despite / In spite of / Notwithstanding** + noun or -ing: *Despite going to bed early, I felt exhausted.* (never *despite of*)
- **Adjective / adverb + as / though + subject + verb**: *Tired as I was, I finished my homework.*
- **Linking two sentences:** *That said, …* · *Even so, …* · *Be that as it may, …* · *Nevertheless, …*

Practice from the Learning Path, with answers

Sentence	Answer	Why
Although I love weekends, I find them hard to organise. MUCH → ___ weekends, I find them hard to organise.	**Much as I love**	Much as + clause.

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Sentence	Answer	Why
I was very tired, but I finished my homework. AS → Tired ___ , I finished my homework.	**as I was**	Adjective + as + subject + verb.
I went to bed early, but I still felt exhausted. DESPITE → ___ to bed early, I still felt exhausted.	**Despite going / Despite having gone**	Despite + -ing.
It's a useful routine, although it's tiring. ALBEIT → It's a useful, ___ , routine.	**albeit tiring**	albeit + adjective.
Open cloze: In spite ___ the noise, I slept well.	**of**	in spite of + noun.
Open cloze: The plan is ambitious. That ___ , it's worth trying.	**said**	That said = however.
Open cloze: Hard ___ she tried, she couldn't wake up before nine.	**as / though**	Adverb + as / though + subject + verb.
Open cloze: Be that as it ___ , we still have to finish by Friday.	**may**	Fixed phrase: be that as it may.

Learning Path 4 · Present Simple & Phrasal verbs

Present tenses at C2: stative verbs and the present perfect continuous

How it works

- **Stative verbs with two meanings:** *I think it's late* (opinion) vs *I'm thinking of joining a gym* (considering). Also *have*, *see*, *taste*, *appear*, *be*: *He's being difficult* (behaving, temporarily).
- **Present perfect continuous** for an activity with visible results or for emphasis on duration: *I've been revising all afternoon, so I'm shattered.*
- **Present simple for scheduled events** and in time clauses about the future: *The train leaves at 7.15.* · *I'll call you when I get home.*
- **Phrasal verbs:** with a pronoun object, separable verbs must be split: *turn it off* (not *turn off it*); three-part verbs never split: *put up with it*.

Practice from the Learning Path, with answers

Sentence	Answer	Why
I am considering joining the climbing club. THINKING → I ___ the climbing club.	**am thinking of joining / am thinking about joining**	think (dynamic) = consider.
He is behaving very rudely today. BEING → He ___ today.	**is being very rude**	be in the continuous = behaving.
I started revising at two and I'm still doing it. BEEN → I ___ two o'clock.	**have been revising since**	Present perfect continuous + since.
I can't tolerate this noise any longer. PUT → I can't ___ this noise any longer.	**put up with**	Three-part phrasal verb, never split.
Open cloze: Switch the TV off, please. → Switch ___ off, please. (pronoun)	**it**	Pronoun between verb and particle.
Open cloze: I'll text you as soon as I ___ home. (arrive)	**get**	Present simple in future time clauses.

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Sentence	Answer	Why
I'm trying to eat less sugar. CUT → I'm trying to ___ sugar.	**cut down on**	cut down on = reduce.
She recovered quickly after a bad start. BOUNCED → She ___ after a bad start.	**bounced back quickly**	bounce back = recover.

Learning Path 5 · Healthy habits

Advice and hypothesis at C2

How it works

- **It's (high / about) time + past simple**: *It's high time you went to bed.*
- **would rather + past simple** (someone else): *I'd rather you didn't eat in my room.*
- **Inverted conditionals** (formal): *Were you to sleep more, you'd feel better.* · *Had I known, I'd have gone to bed earlier.* · *Should you feel unwell, rest.*
- **Formal advice:** *You'd be well advised to…* · *It might be worth + -ing…* · *If I were in your shoes, I'd…*
- **But for / Without** + noun = if it were not for: *But for my alarm, I'd never get up.*

Practice from the Learning Path, with answers

Sentence	Answer	Why
You should go to bed now; it's late. TIME → It's ___ to bed.	**high time you went / about time you went**	It's high time + past simple.
If you slept more, you'd feel better. WERE → ___ more, you'd feel better.	**Were you to sleep**	Inverted second conditional.
If I had known about the test, I would have revised. HAD → ___ about the test, I would have revised.	**Had I known**	Inverted third conditional.
I'd prefer you not to use your phone at dinner. RATHER → I'd ___ your phone at dinner.	**rather you did not use / rather you didn't use**	would rather + past simple.
If it weren't for my alarm, I'd never get up. BUT → ___ alarm, I'd never get up.	**But for my**	But for + noun.
It would be a good idea for you to cut down on caffeine. ADVISED → You'd ___ down on caffeine.	**be well advised to cut**	be well advised to + infinitive.
Open cloze: It might be worth ___ (try) a new routine.	**trying**	worth + -ing.
Open cloze: If I ___ in your shoes, I'd talk to the coach.	**were**	If I were…

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